Name: .....
ID: .....

AOU
الجامعة العربية المفتوحة
Arab Open University

Arab Open University
FACULTY OF LANGUAGE STUDIES
E304B
Exploring English Grammar (II)
All Branches
MTA Exam

2024-2025 / Spring
Date: 9 April 2025
9:30 -11:30

Section: _____

Number of Exam Pages: 11 (Including this cover sheet)	**Time Allowed: 2 hours**

INSTRUCTION

1. Allow approximately 10 minutes to read the instructions on this page and to read through the whole examination paper.

2. There are TWO parts to this MTA examination paper:

Part A (15 marks): There are FOUR practical questions. You are required to answer THREE questions only; ***if you answer all the four questions, only the first three will be marked.***

Part B (15 marks): There is ONE compulsory essay question. You are required to answer it.

3. Carefully follow the instructions in each part.

4. In your answer, make sure that you:

- clearly write the number of the question which you decide to answer.
- cross out any rough notes you make which you do not wish to be marked/graded.

5. Review your answers carefully paying attention to your grammar, spelling, and punctuation as well as to relevant textual elements (e.g., paragraphing, cohesion & coherence) as part of the mark for each question will be given to language accuracy and text organization

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PART A

Answer THREE Questions only (15 marks)

If you answer all, only the first three will be corrected.

Question 1:

Each of the following clauses has different types of lexical cohesion indicated by the words/phrases in **bold**. Write the type of lexical cohesion for each as:

- **Repetition** (same word repeated)
- **Antonymy** (words with opposite meanings)
- **Synonymy** (words with similar meanings)
- **Meronymy** (part-whole relationship)
- **Co-meronymy** (two words that are parts of the same whole)
- **Hyponymy** (specific term related to a general category)
- **Co-hyponymy** (two or more words that fall under the same category)

(5 marks: 1 mark each)

1. The athlete was **strong**, displaying incredible **power** during the competition.

_____

2. The **documentary** was informative, but I preferred the **film** for its storytelling.

_____

3. The zoo houses **lions**, **tigers**, and **leopards**.

_____

4. The test required students to compare **synonyms** and **antonyms**.

_____

5. The **bicycle's frame** was sturdy, but the **chain** and **pedals** needed replacement.

_____

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Question 2:

Underline the theme(s) in the following clauses and identify each as **marked or unmarked**.

(5 marks: underlining theme(s) = 0.5 mark and labelling the theme(s) = 0.5)

1. In the face of budget cuts, the university managed to expand its research programs.

_____

2. Climate change poses a serious threat to global ecosystems.

_____

3. By adopting sustainable practices, companies can reduce their environmental impact.

_____

4. The internet has revolutionized the way people communicate.

_____

5. Through extensive training, athletes can enhance their performance significantly.

_____

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Question 3:

Each of the following clauses has different types of grammatical cohesion indicated by the underlined words/phrases in **bold**. Write the type of grammatical cohesion for each as:

- **Text connector** (links ideas across sentences)
- **Anaphoric reference** (refers back to something previously mentioned)
- **Cataphoric reference** (refers forward to something that will be mentioned)
- **Noun substitution** (a noun phrase replaced with a substitute word)
- **Verb substitution** (a verb phrase replaced with a substitute verb)
- **Clause substitution** (a whole clause replaced with a substitute)
- **Ellipsis** (a part of the clause is omitted but understood)

(5 marks: 1 mark each)

1. **This** will be the key focus of the next meeting: the strategy for expanding into new markets.

_____

2. The company faced financial difficulties. **As a result**, several employees were laid off.

_____

3. The researchers conducted multiple trials before publishing their findings. **These** suggest a significant breakthrough.

_____

4. Some students submitted their assignments early, but **others** waited until the last minute.

_____

5. The teacher asked them to complete the exercise, but only a few **did so**.

_____

ASSESSMENT

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Question 4:

Read each clause and underline the Noun Group **(NG)**. Then, circle Head Noun **(HN)** in each Noun Group and **identify the function** of each *premodifier* as one of the following:

Determiner **(D)** – Specifies the noun (e.g., articles, demonstratives, possessives).

Numerative **(NU)** – Indicates quantity or order.

Describer **(Des)** – Adds descriptive qualities (adjectives).

Classifier **(C)** – Specifies the type or category of the noun.

(5 marks; each correct HN = 0.5 mark and labelling its premodifier items correctly = 0.5 mark)

1. Those three remarkable medical breakthroughs revolutionized treatment methods.

_____

2. A significant environmental crisis threatens biodiversity.

_____

3. The several innovative technological advancements transformed modern industries.

_____

4. This groundbreaking psychological theory reshaped our understanding of human behavior.

_____

5. Many influential economic policies shaped global trade.

_____

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PART B
Compulsory Essay Writing

Write an essay (400 - 450 words) in which you explain and discuss ***cohesive reference*** (chains of reference) as a grammatical resource to make the text below 'hang together': ***(15 marks)***

What is cohesive reference? *(3 marks)*

What are its structural and functional types? *(6 marks)*

Why do speakers/writers use it? *(3 marks)*

How can it be used effectively? *(3 marks)*

Your answer must be full, clear, and focused. Illustrate your answer with appropriate examples from the given text. ***Use your own language.***

Text:

In the past decade, social media platforms have become a dominant force in communication, transforming the way people interact with each other and with the world. With billions of users worldwide, these platforms have not only facilitated real-time connections but also shaped public discourse. However, as social media grows in influence, there have been rising concerns about privacy, misinformation, and the mental health impacts of constant connectivity. Despite these challenges, many argue that the positives outweigh the negatives, pointing to the ability of social media to bring together communities, amplify voices, and provide a platform for free expression. In response, companies and governments are taking steps to regulate the use of these platforms and mitigate their negative effects, but the debate over how to balance freedom and security remains ongoing.

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